

✓ Concrete example (AI & Health)

Initial question:

“How does deep learning improve cardiovascular disease detection?”

Added columns :

Article Method Dataset Metric Limitation

Questions used :

- What model was used?
- What dataset was used?
- What evaluation metric was reported?
- What were the study limitations?

✓ Why add columns ?

The columns allow for the automatic extraction of:

- Methods used
- Datasets
- Evaluation metrics
- Limitations
- Future work
- Study population

This is what transforms Elicit into a comparative analysis tool, not just a search engine.

✓ Steps to add a column

1. Start a search

- Open Elicit
- Ask a specific question

Example :

“How is deep learning used in road accident severity prediction?”

- Elicit displays a list of items in table format.

2. 2. Click on “Add column” (or “+ Column”)

In the results table :

→ ☐ Click on Add column (top right of the table).

3. 3. Choose the column type

You generally have two options :

☐ **A. Custom question (the most powerful)**

Type a question in **English**, for example:

- “What dataset was used?”
- “What evaluation metric was reported?”
- “What were the main limitations?”
- “Is the model validated in real-world conditions?”

Elicit will read the summaries (and sometimes the PDF) and automatically fill in the column.

☐ **B. Predefined field**

Some columns may be suggested automatically:

- Study type
- Intervention

- Population
- Outcomes

✓ Teaching tip

Ask the students to:

1. Add a “Limitation” column
2. Add a “Future work” column
3. Identify the common limitations
4. Deduce a research gap

P.S. : Best practices

- ✓ Formulate clear and precise questions
- ✓ Check the answers in the original PDF
- ✓ Rephrase if the column is incorrectly filled in

Example:

✗ **Bad:** “Dataset?”

✓ **Good:** “What dataset was used in this study?”

✓ If the column is not filled correctly

- Rephrase the question
- Simplify the wording
- Check if the PDF is accessible

Good luck !

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